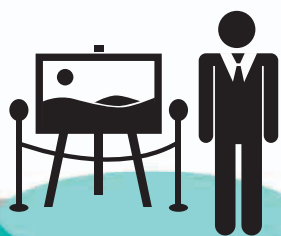
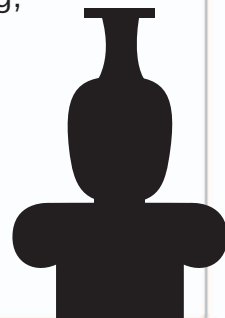


MUSEUM CURATOR



JOB DESCRIPTION

A museum or gallery curator manages a collection of historical artifacts or works of art, overseeing exhibitions and new initiatives. This role can involve acquiring, caring for, displaying, and interpreting exhibits, as well as marketing and fundraising activities. Curators also manage budgets and staff, and build relationships with donors, partner institutions, and artists and artist estates.



SALARY

Curatorial assistant ★★★★★

Head curator ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Funding falls during economic downturns • Employers include museums, galleries, and heritage sites • Growth in contract work, but fewer permanent positions available

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Art • History • Languages • Archaeology • Science • Design • Education • Architecture • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree is required and postgraduate study is desirable. Larger museums recruit graduates as apprentice curators.



LIFESTYLE Full-time curators usually have regular hours, but working on evenings and weekends is common when preparing for an exhibition.



LOCATION Most work is based at a museum, gallery, or heritage site. Travel may be necessary to attend conferences or deliver artifacts.



THE REALITIES Competition for jobs is strong, so working in a lower-paid assistant-level position is necessary to gain sufficient experience to progress.

CAREER PATHS

Museum curators usually hold a degree or postgraduate qualification, and often contribute to research or teaching in their specialized area of interest. Reputation and expertise can lead to a role in a larger, more prestigious collection of exhibits, or a senior position in museum management.

MUSEUM ASSISTANT You can apply for jobs as a clerical or visitor-services assistant at a museum or gallery straight from high school. You will need good grades in history, English, or a related subject. Work experience in a museum is beneficial.



GRADUATE You can earn a degree in museum- or heritage-studies, but an undergraduate or graduate qualification in a subject relevant to a particular collection may qualify you to apply for junior or assistant curating posts.

